

Thieves in Japan, beware of the T-34
If the world is ever taken over by machines, it is sure to start in Japan. Behold the latest little toy that has rolled out from Japanese factories - a robot patroller that throws a net on any burglar that comes in its path. The bot is controlled by a phone.



Clean your teeth with photons
Throw out those tubes of toothpaste. That is what Smart Miracle's laser toothbrush suggests anyway. Fry the germs and clean your teeth with a laser beam - its just what all the cool people are doing these days. And no, it won't burn out your eyes in case you cannot aim the beam properly.



Escape

WHAT'S THAT SMELL?

Smellists rejoice

Those innovative guys at Japan got together and decided that the internet did not give enough of an olfactory sensation to surfers. They decided to take Google maps, and add places to it tagged with unique smells. They are the Nio-Bu, the connoisseurs of smell, and they hang out at www.nioibu.com.

The entire web site is in Japanese, so you will have to use Google's translation tool to make any sense of it. Even in English though, sense will be a difficult thing to find. What you will find though, is where in the world you can smell filthy roadside garbage, cats with bad breath, spilt wine on carpet, roasted cow-dung or dry spit and

chai. For some reason, the site assumes that all grandmother's houses smell the same, but no one has really taken the trouble to refute their claims. Not all the smells are bad though, you can check out a freshly unboxed Mac, and strangely enough, even what our sun smells like, right here on Earth.

You can add your own odours to the list, and if that does not occupy your time, you can look at a list of photos of people "smelling the smell". As of now, there is no mechanism by which the website can actually let surfers get a whiff of their long list of strange odours, but the Japanese act fast when an idea strikes them.



ANONYMOUS COLLECTIVE GETS REASON TO FLAME

Scientologists against HIV+ protesters

Something of an in-joke in the global Internet community. Open discussion across image boards, forums and blogs about the dubious activities of the scientologists, saw the Church of Scientology targeting individuals in a number of cases. The internet community organised themselves into the Anonymous Collective (so that the Church of Scientology could not play hardball) and continued circulating jokes online. Also, real world protestors (with hidden identities) started displaying their complete lack of sympathy for the Scientologists.

The Church of Scientology is notorious for having a many-tiered hierarchy, where you learn and evolve towards your inner immortal soul. The Aliens have something to do with it too, but no one really knows exactly what. By the end of it, you get to be Superman, or Tom Cruise, or something like that. On the way there though, you get a few evolution points for banning protesters against their activities and beliefs.

Whatever Happened To... Google Lively

Most of us have now come to accept that not everything Google touches turns to gold. Yes, there are definitely some things Google tried doing and well, didn't quite work out. One such ambitious project was Lively a web-based virtual environment launched by Google sometime in July last year. The idea was to create a "chat experience" using avatars in which one can communicate, move around and interact in a virtual world. Its almost as if Google said "hey if Second Life is doing it why cant we? Of course there were differences - unlike Second Life, the Lively users could not buy and sell products. Since there was no user-generated content on Lively, items such as hairstyles, clothing and furniture were limited to a catalog of pre-designed selections. In Google Lively up to 20 people could occupy a room and chat with one another. Text appeared as cartoon-style bubbles atop the avatars. Users could design their own virtual environments by hanging YouTube videos and pics from Picasa on the walls like pieces of art. The rooms could be embedded into blogs and Facebook pages.

But in November Google announced on its blog that it plans to shut down Lively by the end of December. Calling it an "experiment", the blog goes on to say "It has been a tough decision, but we want to ensure that we prioritise our resources and focus more on our core search, ads and apps business. We'd encourage all Lively users to capture your hard work by taking videos and screenshots of your rooms."

These protesters are people who picket outside the premises of any building owned by the Church of Scientology, over issues like their underhanded techniques for curtailing protesters, their belief of homosexuality as a disease, and providing financial aids to anti-gay legislations.

The Church of Scientology is by no means harmless, and they have powerful ways of stopping protesters, both legal and illegal. The Church of Scientology has gone ahead and enforce legal restrictions on two homosexual HIV+ protesters, one of whom is himself an ex-Scientologist. These protesters are not anonymous and anonymous, but Angry Gay Pope and Happy Smurf. And

no, the aliens were not able to cure Happy Smurf of his "disease".

GET PAID TO VACATION

Remember to feed the fish

In what is dubbed the best job in the world, Australian Tourism authorities will pay one lucky person US \$100,000 (Rs. 6,354,954) for blogging about a fully paid six month hiatus in Australia. You can look up the details and apply through www.islandreefjob.com. What are you expected to do? Hang out at the beach, get a massage or go snorkeling in the great barrier reef. Understandably, the web site received something like



two hundred thousand hits within a day of going up. The job itself has generated a lot of publicity for the employers. Your official post will read out as "The Caretaker of the Islands of the Great Barrier Reef", if you get selected. Not only will you be accommodated on one of the important islands, you will be given permission to include family or a friend. You can apply for the job by sending in a video presentation of yourself. They have received a bunch of submissions. The deadline for entries is the twenty second of February. What are you waiting for? We gave out the URL two paragraphs ago. There is one small catch though, you have to have at least one year prior experience, but we are unsure how they can expect that for a job like this.

CENSORSHIP SO BIG, IT CAN BE SEEN FROM SPACE

China almost bans the web

China has a history of a love-hate relationship with technology. What is normal computer usage around the world is invariably some kind of a crime in China, so every month has its share of odd and outrageous happenings. This month's China related roundup includes a massive crackdown on porn, a crackdown on

People Who Changed Computing

The ubiquitous touch screen is seen in almost everything from ATM machines, PCs to mobile devices to perhaps even vacuum cleaners! Well refrigerators at least. Not only did it make life easy, it made everything fun. Think of the i-phone.



Would it be the same without its touchscreen? Who doesn't like a bit of touchy-feely action right? And we owe it all to Dr Sam Hurst. He developed the first "touch sensor" in 1971 while he was an instructor at University of Kentucky. This was not the transparent touch screen that we know of today. This sensor called the "Elograph" was patented by The University of Kentucky Research Foundation. Dr. Sam Hurst founded his company 'Elographics' (now Elo TouchSystems) and developed a transparent touch screen in 1974 and five wire resistive technology in 1977, which is the most popular touch screen technology. In 1977 Elographics paired with Siemens Corporation to develop a transparent version of the tablet on curved glass so that it could fit over a CRT (cathode ray tube) screen.